

Eric Gabbard

Seattle, WA 98136 | (847) 387-0469 | ericdgabbard@gmail.com | LinkedIn

SUMMARY

Head of Product with 9 years in B2B SaaS and fintech. Most recently owned the full technology roadmap at a venture-backed lender, aligning senior leadership, engineering, and capital markets on one prioritized plan. Builds AI-native product systems hands-on, from agent architecture to the governance model an org runs on.

EXPERIENCE

Backflip | Venture-backed real estate lending fintech (~50 people) | Seattle, WA (Remote)

Head of Product (previously Senior Product Manager) | May 2024 – August 2026

- Led a cross-functional pod through 10+ A/B tests on the acquisition funnel, driving +34% conversion and +26% loan applications on 10% less marketing spend over one quarter against a trailing-twelve-month baseline.
- Saved a product slated for cancellation by proving 6.7x higher retention (60% vs 9% at Month 1) and 85% more applications per user, then cut its data costs 90% by isolating the true cost driver and renegotiating to usage-based pricing.
- Chose a full React rebuild of the loan dashboard over incremental patching by weighing throughput gain against migration cost, then led the rebuild end to end, eliminating the database middle layer for a direct CRM front end: median time to close fell 27% (26 to 19 days) and feature throughput roughly tripled.
- Expanded from a single product workstream to the full technology roadmap, taking roadmap ownership of three workstreams, and drove a WIP-reduction exercise with senior leadership that freed engineering capacity for the three highest-priority initiatives.
- Designed a three-variant loan application experiment against two opposed stakeholder agendas, defining a funnel-shape-neutral primary metric that prevented post-hoc result-gaming; the winning variant led submission conversion 4.5% vs 2.0% over 25 days.
- Built an AI system analyzing thousands of sales calls and deal-loss reasons, surfacing objection patterns and rep-level coaching gaps that reshaped sales onboarding and ongoing training.
- Partnered with engineering to ship v1 of a company-wide MCP server as a single authenticated AI data layer across 5 fragmented systems, with OAuth, role-gated permissions and one audit trail, eliminating per-team direct-API sprawl and setting the pattern subsequent AI agents were built on.

Kasasa | Fintech SaaS for community banks and credit unions (150–400 people) | Austin, TX

Senior Product Manager (promoted four times: Associate PM → Senior Associate PM → Product Manager → Senior Product Manager) | October 2017 – February 2024

- Guided a cross-functional team to define, build and launch four new product variations end to end, achieving 75 sales in the first two quarters and \$1.2M in annual revenue.
- Partnered with analytics to identify the key account metrics behind profitability and launch a new rewards program, increasing profitable account behaviors 25%.
- Owned strategy, roadmap and feature design for a self-service support product, directing 5+ engineers and designers to expand client usage 12% and reduce support tickets 10%.
- Oversaw a platform migration of 600 clients to a new SaaS platform and introduced internal tooling that reduced support costs by \$250K.

- Developed a framework to standardize roadmap prioritization across product pods, aligning the executive team and stakeholders on complex cross-organizational initiatives.

Amazon Fulfillment | San Marcos, TX

Area Manager | June 2016 – August 2017

- Led and motivated a 90-member team to become the top-performing shift in pack productivity, quality and outbound efficiency at Amazon's benchmark fulfillment site.

SKILLS

Areas of Expertise: Product Strategy & Roadmapping, Product Vision & 0-to-1 Development, Generative AI Product Strategy, LLM Application & Agent Design, Regulatory & Compliance Navigation, Data-driven Decision Making, OKR & KPI Definition, Stakeholder Management, A/B & Multivariate Experimentation, Funnel Analysis & Optimization, User Research & Customer Insights, Cross-functional Collaboration, Go-to-Market Strategy, Product Lifecycle Management, Agile Product Development

Tools: Claude Code (agentic workflows, custom skills), MCP (Model Context Protocol), PRD authoring, BigQuery (SQL & analytics), HubSpot & HubSpot API, Salesforce, Zapier, n8n, Jira, Confluence, Figma, LaunchDarkly, MixPanel, FullStory, Pendo, Segment, Google Analytics

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Industrial Management | Purdue University Concentration: Operations & Supply Chain Management